

Power BI Interview QnA

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1. What is Power BI?

Answer: Power BI is a business analytics tool by Microsoft that allows users to visualize and share insights from their data. It provides interactive reports and dashboards, integrates with various data sources, and supports real-time data processing.

2. What are the different types of Power BI services?

Answer: Power BI has three main components:

- Power BI Desktop: A Windows application used for data visualization and report creation.
- Power BI Service (Cloud): A cloud-based service for sharing, collaborating, and publishing Power BI reports and dashboards.
- Power BI Mobile: Mobile apps for iOS and Android for viewing and interacting with Power BI reports.

3. What is the difference between Power BI Desktop and Power BI Service?

Answer:

- Power BI Desktop is used for report creation and data transformation. It's a free desktop application.
- Power BI Service is a cloud-based platform used to share and collaborate on reports and dashboards. It allows users to access reports, share dashboards, and collaborate in real-time.

4. What is a Power BI report?

Answer: A Power BI report is a collection of visualizations (such as charts, graphs, and maps) based on a dataset. It can have

multiple pages and is interactive, allowing users to filter and drill down into the data.

5. What is a Power BI dashboard?

Answer: A Power BI dashboard is a single-page, interactive view of key metrics and reports, often designed for quick insights. It aggregates data from multiple reports and datasets and is used for monitoring and decision-making.

6. What are Power BI datasets?

Answer: Datasets in Power BI are collections of data that are imported or connected to in Power BI. A dataset can include tables, queries, and data models, and it serves as the foundation for reports and dashboards.

7. What is DAX in Power BI?

Answer: DAX (Data Analysis Expressions) is a formula language used in Power BI to define calculations and create custom metrics or aggregations. It is similar to Excel formulas but specifically designed for data models in Power BI.

8. What is Power Query?

Answer: Power Query is a data transformation and preparation tool used within Power BI to connect to various data sources, clean, transform, and load data into Power BI for analysis. It uses a language called M for query expressions.

9. What are calculated columns in Power BI?

Answer: A calculated column is a new column created in the data model using a DAX formula. It performs row-level calculations on

the data, and the results are stored in the model.

10. What are measures in Power BI?

Answer: Measures are calculations that are computed on the fly during analysis using DAX. Unlike calculated columns, measures are not stored in the model but are dynamically calculated during the query execution, typically aggregations like SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, etc.

11. What are slicers in Power BI?

Answer: Slicers are visual elements that allow users to filter the data in a report or dashboard by selecting specific values or ranges. They help in making reports interactive and focusing on specific subsets of data.

12. What is the difference between row-level security and role-level security in Power BI?

Answer:

- Row-level security (RLS): Controls access to data within a report based on the user's role or identity, restricting what data they can see.
- Role-level security: A method to define roles in Power BI and filter data accordingly based on the role.

13. What is a Power BI Gateway?

Answer: A Power BI Gateway is software that acts as a bridge between on-premises data sources and the Power BI cloud service. It allows data refreshes and live data connections from local databases to Power BI.

14. What is a Power BI workspace?

Answer: A workspace is a container for organizing and managing reports, datasets, and dashboards in Power BI Service. It allows collaboration, access control, and sharing of content among users.

15. What is the difference between DirectQuery and Import mode in Power BI?

Answer:

- Import mode: Data is imported and stored in Power BI's in-memory model. It provides better performance but is limited by the size of the model.
- DirectQuery mode: Data remains in the source system, and queries are sent live to the data source. It supports larger datasets but may have slower performance due to the need for constant querying.

16. What are the different types of relationships in Power BI?

Answer: Power BI supports three types of relationships:

- One-to-many: One record in a table relates to many records in another table.
- Many-to-one: Many records in one table relate to one record in another table.
- Many-to-many: Many records in both tables can relate to each other.

17. What is the use of Power BI Q&A?

Answer: Power BI Q&A is a feature that allows users to type natural language queries (like "total sales for last year") and get instant answers in the form of visualizations. It uses machine

learning and natural language processing to interpret user questions.

18. How does Power BI handle large datasets?

Answer: Power BI handles large datasets using a combination of methods:

- Data compression techniques.
- DirectQuery mode for live connections to large datasets.
- Incremental data refresh to refresh only a subset of data.
- Aggregations and pre-processed data models to optimize performance.

19. What is a Power BI content pack?

Answer: A content pack is a pre-packaged solution that contains reports, datasets, and dashboards. Power BI provides content packs for many popular applications like Salesforce, Google Analytics, and Dynamics 365.

20. What is Power BI Embedded?

Answer: Power BI Embedded is a service that allows developers to embed Power BI reports and dashboards into their own applications, providing interactive analytics within custom business applications.

21. What are Power BI tiles?

Answer: A Power BI tile is a visual representation of data from a report or dashboard. It is a snapshot of a visual (like a chart or graph) that can be pinned to a dashboard for easy access.

22. Explain the importance of Power BI bookmarks.

Answer: Bookmarks in Power BI allow users to capture the current view of a report (including filters, slicers, and visual settings) and save it. Users can then create navigation between different views or set up dynamic reporting experiences.

23. What is the role of Azure in Power BI?

Answer: Azure plays a key role in Power BI, especially with services like Azure Data Lake, Azure SQL Database, and Azure Synapse Analytics. These can be used as data sources for Power BI and help with data storage, processing, and analytics.

24. What are drillthrough filters in Power BI?

Answer: Drillthrough filters in Power BI allow users to right-click on a data point and drill through to a detailed report or page that focuses on that specific data point, providing a deeper analysis.

25. How do you create a calculated table in Power BI?

Answer: A calculated table is created using DAX formulas in the Data View. It's based on existing tables and expressions that allow you to filter or aggregate data in a new table.

26. What is the purpose of Power BI's "Get Data" feature?

Answer: The "Get Data" feature in Power BI allows users to connect to a variety of data sources (Excel, SQL Server, web, APIs, etc.) to import data into Power BI for analysis.

27. What is incremental refresh in Power BI?

Answer: Incremental refresh is a technique in Power BI that enables efficient data refresh by only updating the new or modified data rather than refreshing the entire dataset.

28. What are some best practices for Power BI report performance?

Answer:

- Use DirectQuery for large datasets.
- Avoid complex DAX calculations in real-time.
- Use star schema for your data model.
- Minimize visuals on a page to reduce load times.
- Enable query folding in Power Query for optimal performance.

29. What is the difference between Power BI Free, Pro, and Premium?

Answer:

- Power BI Free: Limited features; for individual use.
- Power BI Pro: For sharing, collaboration, and publishing reports, with more advanced features.
- Power BI Premium: Provides dedicated cloud resources, better performance, and enterprise-level features for large organizations.

30. How do you perform version control in Power BI?

Answer: Power BI does not have built-in version control, but users can use Git or other version control tools for Power BI files (PBIX). Versioning can be managed manually by saving different versions or using third-party tools like Power BI Desktop GitHub integration.

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